



Connecting and Automating Analysis & Planning

From backlog to release — one chat, every step.





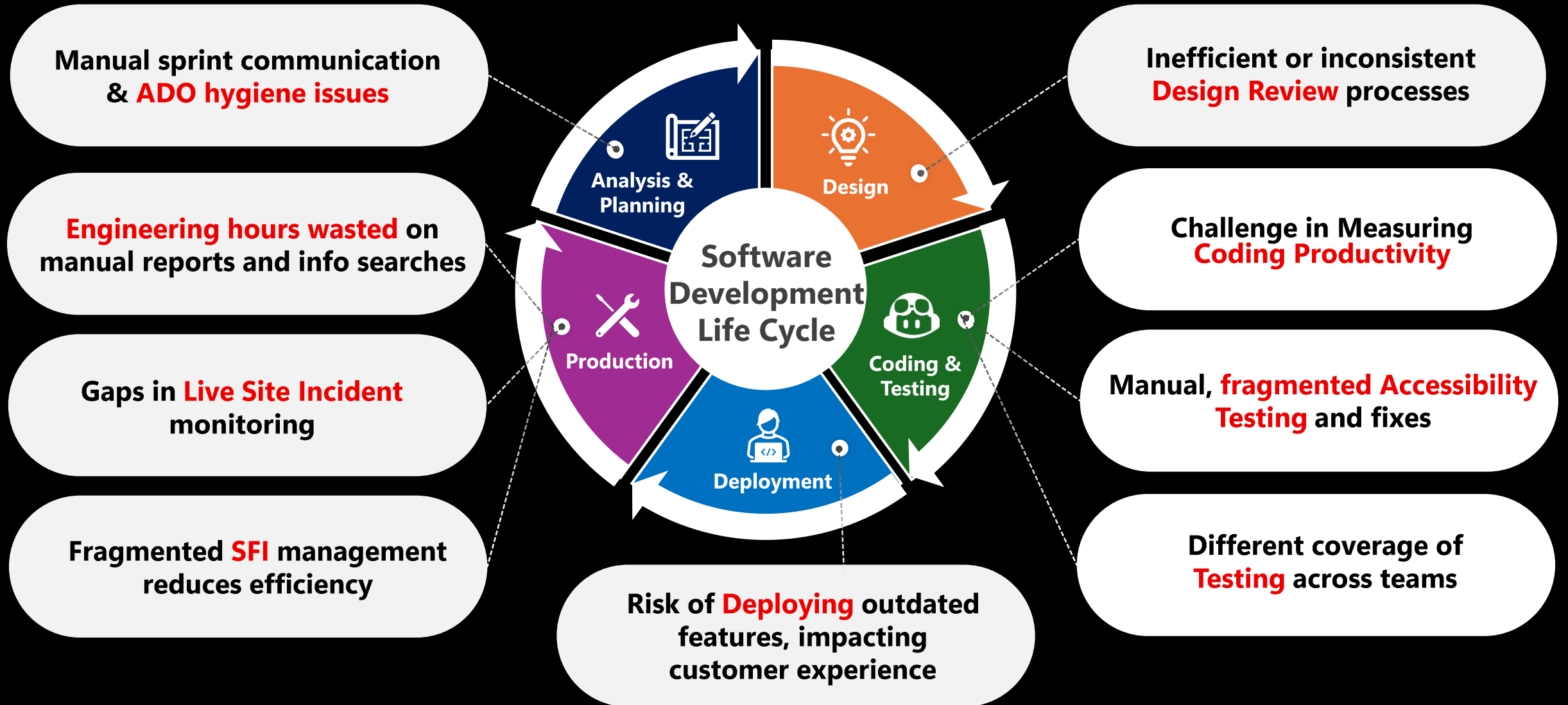
Feedback!

Share with us:

- 1. Learnings you've had so far**
- 2. Whitespaces you might still find**

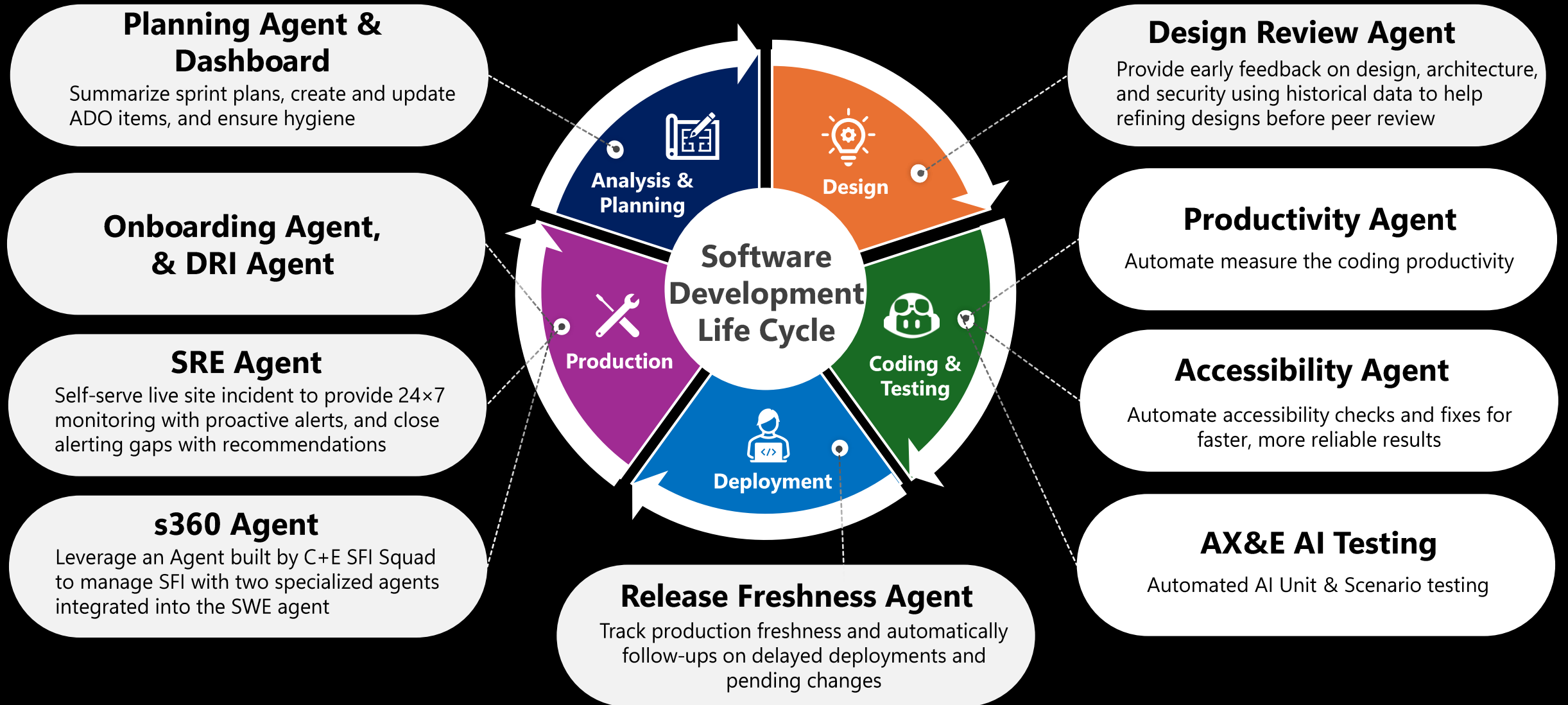
Areas Impacting Engineering Velocity & Quality

Present State: Pain Points in Our SDLC



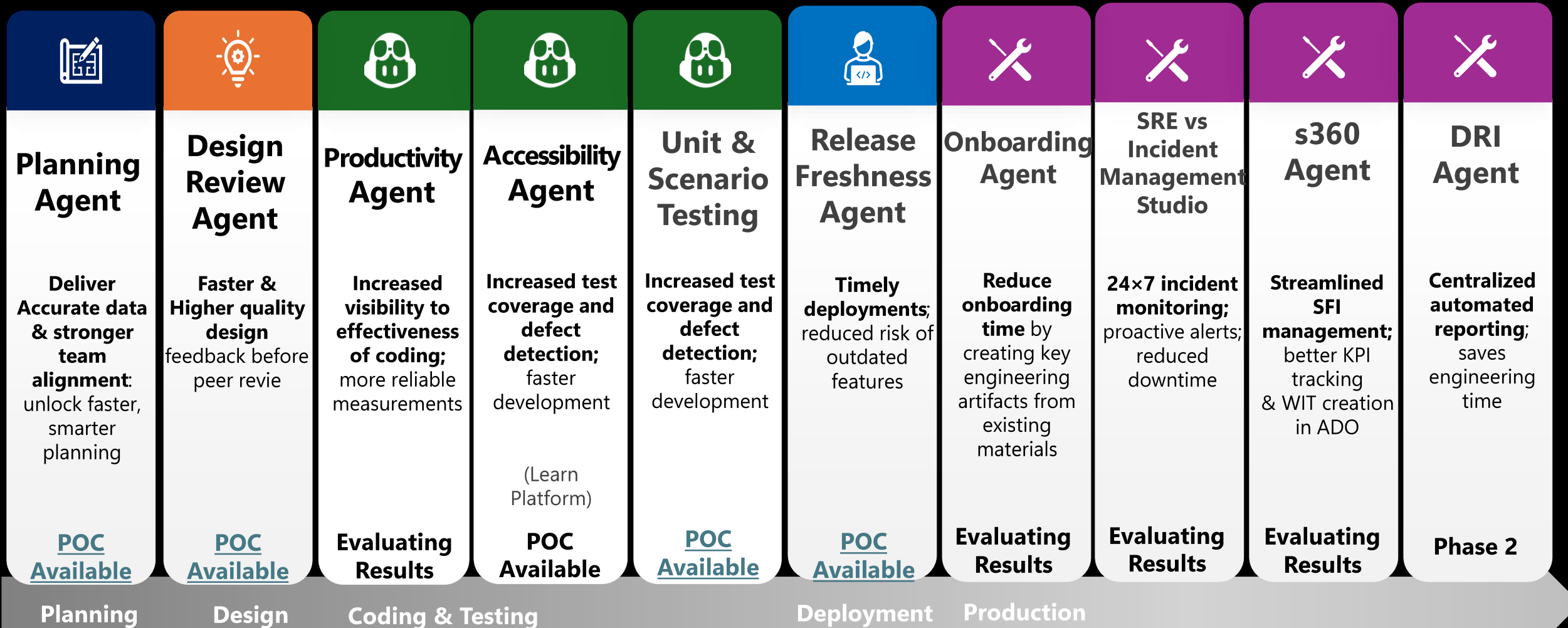
Accelerate Productivity by embedding AI

Our Proposal: AI-Driven Solutions for SDLC Improvement



Improve Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC)

Accelerate AX&E Engineering productivity by embedding AI into everyday work



**Zero Production Touch: Keep work in Learn, maintain only, no further expansion*

Why wire agents into your trackers



Context is scattered across tools

Code lives in GitHub, work lives in Jira or Azure DevOps, decisions live in chat. Agents that only see code make decisions blind to the plan and ship the wrong thing fast.

Manual handoffs break the loop

Developers copy-paste between IDE, tracker, and PR. Each switch is friction — and a chance for the audit trail to drift from what really shipped.

Releases without traceable evidence

When stories close without linked artifacts, compliance reviews fall back to screenshots and trust. Agents can produce evidence — pytest output, run JSON, sign-off comments — but only if you wire them into the tracker.

The AI-powered developer platform

Scale and governance



Plan

Issues

Projects

Spaces

/planning

Teams + Slack

Boards



Code

Editor/IDEs

Copilot CLI

/coding

Mission control

Custom agents



Verify

Pull Requests

/code-review

/secure + /auto-fix

/testing

Code quality



Deploy

Actions (CI/CD)

Releases

Apps

AI Workflows

Custom agents

Pipelines



Operate

Metrics/ROI

Spark Runtime

SRE Agent

MCP Integrations



Agent control plane



MCP + Custom Agents for the backlog

Set the context once. Drive every ticket.

Define your agents once in `.github/agents/`, and let Copilot orchestrate the entire delivery lifecycle. By wiring the **Story-Implementer** and **Sprint Sign-off** agents to the **Jira MCP** and **Azure DevOps MCP**, Copilot can drive every backlog item through a consistent loop: **read** → **reason** → **comment** → **transition**.

Today, we'll use these two MCPs to interact directly with Jira and Azure DevOps from the IDE—reading work items, updating status, adding comments, and signing off stories. Once connected, Copilot becomes the execution layer that ensures every ticket follows the same automated flow.





What is the Story-Implementer agent

- Takes a backlog ticket → drives it through read, reason, comment, transition
- Defined as a Markdown contract under `.github/agents/` with scoped MCP tools
- Runs against the patched local Jira/ADO MCP servers — every call is logged and auditable
- Human-approved by design: can't close a sprint; every transition shows up in Jira/ADO



Lab 06

Backlog Workflow: Jira MCP, Azure DevOps MCP & Custom Agents



Today's Lab

Setup

Connect to the Jira or Azure DevOps MCPs

Part 1 — Backlog Demo

Part 1 — Read a real Jira ticket through the patched MCP server and pick one to drive.

Part 2 — Connect Agents to the MCP Server

Part 2 — Connect the Jira and Azure DevOps MCP servers and verify agents can see your live backlog.

Part 3 — Custom Agents

Run the Story-Implementer agent through a full read → reason → comment → transition cycle.

Part 4 — Sprint Sign-off End-to-End

Run the Sprint Sign-off agent across the backlog and review the transitions and comments it logs.





Thank you